Curriculum Vitae

Personal Data

Title	Dr. (Ms.)
First name	Apoorva
Name	Upadhyaya
Nationality	Indian
Birth date	23.09.1992
Current position	Researcher, (TV-L 13, 100% position)
Current institution(s)/site(s), country	Institut für Elektrotechnik und Informatik, Leibniz University Hannover, L3S Research Center

Qualifications and Career

Stages	**Periods and Details**
Degree	2018-20 Master in Technology, Department of Computer Science and Technology, Indian Institute of Technology, Patna (IIT Patna), Bihar, India 2010-2014 Bachelor of Technology, Computer Engineering, YMCA University of Science and Technology, Haryana, India
Doctorate	April 2023- April 2026, Leibniz University Hannover, L3S Research Center, under the supervision of Prof. Wolfgang Nejdl
Stages of academic/professional career	Oct 2021- Present Researcher (TV-L 13, 100% position) L3S Research Center 2020-21 Researcher, Genomics Labs, Life Science & Health Care Research & Innovation Lab, Tata Consultancy Services 2014-2018 System Engineer, Tata Consultancy Services

Activities in the Research System

2026 Program Committee, Wafl Workshop, ECML PKDD 2026

2026 EU-Project Research Visit to IIT Kharagpur, India, under Prof. Niloy Ganguly

2026 Teaching Assistant and mentoring students for AI in Healthcare

2026 Doctoral thesis defense research talk and presentation

2026 Research talk and accepted paper presentation in Los Angeles, US for ICWSM

2026 Program Committee, Demo Track, ECIR 2026

2025 Program Committee and Session Moderator, Workshop on Generative AI for Disinformation and Misinformation Detection, WSDM 2025

2025 Research Visit to Sapienza University of Rome, Italy, under Prof. Roberto Navigli.

2025 Presentation talk at IJCAI* 2025, Montreal, Canada, for the accepted research work.

2025 EU-Project Plenary Meeting: Presentation of leading work packages and developing federated learning and explainable AI components

2025 Teaching Assistant, Leibniz University Hannover Federated Learning Coursework (Winter Semester 2025/2026)

2025 Teaching Assistant, Leibniz University Hannover AI seminar (Summer Semester 2025)

2024 Poster presentation at CIKM, 2024, for the accepted research work

2024 Teaching Assistant, Leibniz University Hannover Federated Learning Coursework (Winter Semester 2024/2025)

2023 Program Committee, Workshop on High-performance Artificial Intelligence in Education co-located with 22nd International Conference of the Italian Association for Artificial Intelligence (AIxIA 2023)

2023 Research Talks and presentations for various conferences such as ACM Web*, IJCAI*, EMNLP*, AAAI ICWSM

2023 Research presentations and assist in coordinating the Project Symposium (SoMeCliCS: Social Media and Climate Change)

2022-2026 Reviewer in conferences such as ECML PKDD, ICWSM, EMNLP* and journals like Elsevier Information Processing & Management, EPJ Data Science, ACM Computing Survey, and others

2022-2023 Conduct Pilot studies with students:

- at the IGS List school in Hannover, to understand how Artificial Intelligence can be helpful for students in learning the viewpoints towards climate change;
- at the Italian secondary school to understand how students interact with AI to detect moral sentiments in social media

Supervision of Researchers in Early Career Phases

Supervised ***2 Bachelor's*** theses as a ***Mentor***: “Federated Learning of Large Language Models on Agricultural Drone Imagery Using Simulated Flight Planning” and Exploring ChatGPT for Drone Applications: Prompts, Dialogues, and Task Adaptability”.

Scientific Results

- **Upadhyaya, A.**, & Sikdar, S. (2026). When Safety Speaks a Language: A Mechanistic Analysis of Safety-Language Identity Entanglement in LLMs. Submitted to ACL ARR, August 2026. (Under review)
- Moroni, L., et al. (2026). Culture-Wiki: Benchmarking Different Cultures in Knowledge Recalling Tasks. (To be submitted to ACL ARR, October, 2026).
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Nejdl, W., & Fisichella, M. (2026). Towards Transparent Stance Detection: A Zero-Shot Approach Using Implicit and Explicit Interpretability. In Proceedings of the 20th International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM). (CORE rank A)
- Murashilli, V. V., Khatri, K. K., **Upadhyaya, A.**, & Fisichella, M. (2026). Which Layers Matter? A Study of Layer-Selective LoRA in Centralized and Federated Fine-Tuning. In Proceedings of the ECML PKDD 2026 Workshop (To be published).
- Heitbreder, J., Jesinghaus, C., Köpp, J., **Upadhyaya, A.**, & Fisichella, M. (2026). MTL-FLoRA: Federated Low-Rank Adaptation for Multi-Task Learning. In Proceedings of the ECML PKDD 2026 Workshop (To be published).
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Schicchi, D., Taibi, D., & Fisichella, M. (2026). Exploring how students interact with AI for detecting moral sentiments in social media. Array, 30, 100941. Elsevier. (Q1, IF: 5.3)
- **Upadhyaya, A**., Nejdl, W., & Fisichella, M. (2025) Towards Transparent Stance Detection: A Zero-Shot Approach Using Implicit and Explicit Interpretability. Accepted at International AAAI conference on web and social media (ICWSM). (CORE rank A) .

- **Upadhyaya, A**., Nejdl, W., & Fisichella, M. (2025) Interpretable zero-shot stance detection with proactive content intervention. Information Processing & Management, 62, no. 6 (2025): 104223. (Q1, IF: 8.1).
- **Upadhyaya, A**., Nejdl, W., & Fisichella, M. (2025) Enhancing Online Climate Discourse: A Two-Stage Framework for Climate Content Categorization and Moderation. In Proceedings of the Thirty-Fourth International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence, pp. 9890-9898. 2025 (IJCAI). (CORE rank A*)
- Ghosh, M., Srivastava, S., **Upadhyaya, A.**, Halder, R., & Chandra, J. (2025, April). Catalog: Exploiting joint temporal dependencies for enhanced phishing detection on ethereum. In Proceedings of the ACM on Web Conference 2025 (pp. 969-977). (CORE rank A*)
- **Upadhyaya, A**., Nejdl, W., & Fisichella, M. (2024) Harnessing Empathy and Ethics for Relevance Detection and Information Categorization in Climate and COVID-19 Tweets. In *Proceedings of the 33rd ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management*, pp. 4091-4095. 2024 (CORE rank A)
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Fisichella, M., & Nejdl, W. (2023, December). Toxicity, morality, and speech act guided stance detection. In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023 (pp. 4464-4478). (CORE rank A)
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Fisichella, M., & Nejdl, W. (2023, April). A multi-task model for emotion and offensive aided stance detection of climate change tweets. In Proceedings of the ACM Web Conference 2023 (pp. 3948-3958). (CORE rank A*)
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Fisichella, M., & Nejdl, W. (2023, August). Intensity-Valued Emotions Help Stance Detection of Climate Change Twitter Data. In IJCAI (pp. 6246-6254). (CORE rank A*)
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Fisichella, M., & Nejdl, W. (2023, June). A multi-task model for sentiment aided stance detection of climate change tweets. In Proceedings of the International AAAI conference on web and social media (Vol. 17, pp. 854-865). (CORE rank A)
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Fisichella, M., & Nejdl, W. (2023). Towards sentiment and temporal aided stance detection of climate change tweets. Information Processing & Management, 60(4), 103325. (Q1, IF: 8.1)
- Schicchi, D., **Upadhyaya, A.**, Fisichella, M., & Taibi, D. (2023). Using ChatGPT to Enhance Students' Behavior in Social Media via the Moral Foundation Theory.
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, Pfeiffer, C., Astappiev, O., Marenzi, I., Lenzer, S., Nehring, A., & Fisichella, M. (2022, July). How learnweb can support science education research on climate change in social media. In International Conference in Methodologies and intelligent Systems for Techhnology Enhanced Learning (pp. 149-154). Cham: Springer International Publishing.
- Saha, T., **Upadhyaya, A.**, Saha, S., & Bhattacharyya, P. (2021). A multitask multimodal ensemble model for sentiment-and emotion-aided tweet act classification. IEEE Transactions on Computational Social Systems, 9(2), 508-517. (IF: 4.5)
- Saha, T., **Upadhyaya, A.**, Saha, S., & Bhattacharyya, P. (2021, June). Towards sentiment and emotion aided multi-modal speech act classification in twitter. In Proceedings of the 2021 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies (pp. 5727-5737). (CORE rank A)
- Priya, S., **Upadhyaya, A.**, Bhanu, M., Kumar Dandapat, S., & Chandra, J. (2020, October). Endea: Ensemble based decoupled adversarial learning for identifying infrastructure damage during disasters. In Proceedings of the 29th ACM international conference on information & knowledge management (pp. 1245-1254). (CORE rank A)
- **Upadhyaya, A.**, & Chandra, J. (2022). Spotting flares: The vital signs of the viral spread of tweets made during communal incidents. ACM Transactions on the Web, 16(4), 1-28. (IF: 2.6).

Academic Distinctions

2026	Securing Magna cum laude in Doctoral thesis writing and presentation.
2020	Secured second position in Master's in the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IIT Patna with 9.1 CGPA
2018	Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering (GATE) qualified with 99.93 percentile (All India Rank 687)
2014	Graduated with first division in Bachelor's in Computer Engineering with overall CGPA of 8.946, YMCAUST, India
2010-08	School topper of senior secondary (93%) and secondary examinations (95.2%) by CBSE Boards, India

Hannover, 07.09.2026